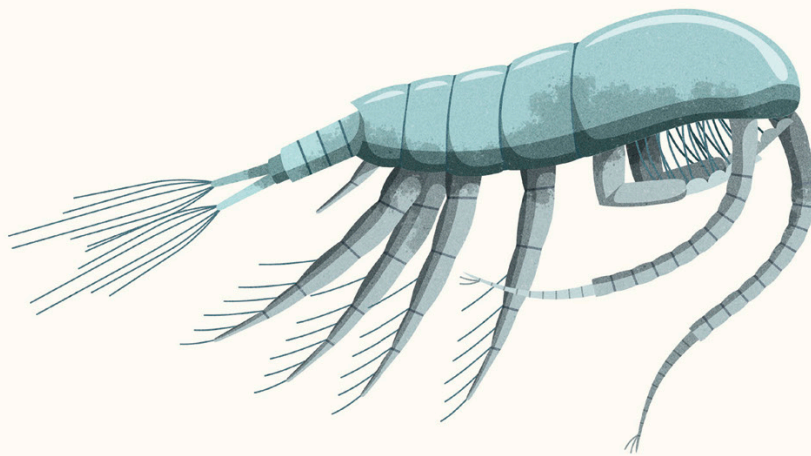


Copepod



*Some copepods are parasites that live
on other animals. One lives on
the eyeball of a shark!*

A tablespoon of water is like a swimming pool to a copepod. Copepods are tiny cousins of shrimp. They swim with a stop-start motion through the water, kicking with their hairy legs. Usually their body is see-through, but some glow blue-green in the dark. Many have a single eye in the centre of their head, just like a cyclops – scary, one-eyed giants from Ancient Greek myths.

Together, copepods make one of the greatest journeys on Earth. By the light of the Moon, masses of them rise to the surface of the sea, all over the world. Every morning, they sink back down to the depths again. This helps them avoid hungry fish during the daytime.